

# JOINTBOX vs ZAL ULTRA

ISP CRM & RADIUS platform  
capability comparison | Aug 2026

## WHY ISPs CHOOSE JOINTBOX

### Money that reconciles

Wallet, invoice and RADIUS move in ONE transaction. Reseller profit is a separate ledger, never mixed into wallet balance — so every rupee is attributable to a person, package and date.

### Nothing is assumed

Disconnect, static-IP and package changes are verified against the live router before the panel reports success. No more “shows offline in the panel, still online on the NAS.”

### Built-in NOC

SNMP device health, per-interface RX/TX graphs, ping / traceroute / TCP / DNS / HTTP diagnostics and down-alerts — inside the CRM. No separate monitoring stack to buy or run.

### Self-healing

Automatic sweeps reconcile wallet↔ledger, RADIUS↔billing and ghost sessions, restore lost credentials, and flag drift instead of silently serving free internet.

## HEAD-TO-HEAD

| Capability                  | Jointbox                                                                                                                             | Zal Ultra                                                                       |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ● <b>Core stack</b>         | TypeScript / NestJS 11, PostgreSQL + Prisma, Next.js 16, Redis + BullMQ, pm2 cluster                                                 | PHP 8 / Laravel, MySQL / MariaDB, Vue.js                                        |
| RADIUS data path            | App and FreeRADIUS share ONE PostgreSQL — no sync lag between billing and auth                                                       | FreeRADIUS 3.x on MySQL                                                         |
| ● <b>Session control</b>    | RFC 3576 CoA + <b>router-API fallback + post-cut verification</b> and full attempt trail                                             | CoA supported (disconnect, bandwidth change)                                    |
| ● <b>Network monitoring</b> | SNMP health polling, interface graphs, latency history, ping/traceroute/TCP/DNS/HTTP, down alerts, syslog roadmap                    | Session logs, connection stats, topology mapping                                |
| Financial integrity         | Double-entry ledger, trial balance, period lock, invoice reversal, refund + expense approvals, <b>nightly wallet↔ledger audit</b>    | Ledger, cashflow, invoice reversal, multi-currency, tax                         |
| Reseller model              | Unlimited tiers; per-tier pricing ladder, credit limits, <b>profit ledger separate from wallet</b> , per-child profit reports        | Reseller → sub-reseller → retailer, independent accounting, profit distribution |
| Permissions                 | Per-role catalogue + <b>per-user deny list</b> , server-side tenant scoping on every route, 2FA, session control, audit log          | Role-based permissions, departments, 2FA, activity + login logs                 |
| ● <b>Field operations</b>   | Job dispatch, technician assignment/SLA, inventory install tracking, fibre OLT/ONU provisioning, outage scheduling + customer notice | Inventory, OLT/ONU support                                                      |
| Automation / API            | Public REST API + API keys, outbound <b>webhooks</b> , background job engine, live SSE feed                                          | RESTful API, Postman collection                                                 |
| Deployment                  | Self-hosted, one-command self-healing updater (auto-installs deps, verifies build, never leaves a half-deploy)                       | Cloud-hosted or on-premise, automated installer, VPN for NAS without public IP  |
| <b>Vendor breadth</b>       | Vendor-agnostic RADIUS/CoA; deepest integration on MikroTik                                                                          | <b>50+ NAS vendors</b> — Cisco, Juniper, vBNG, BiSON, pfSense, Ubiquiti         |
| <b>Payment gateways</b>     | 7 — Stripe, PayPal, Razorpay, bKash, SSLCommerz, JazzCash, Easypaisa                                                                 | <b>11</b> — adds Nagad, PayStack, M-Pesa, NextPay                               |
| <b>Track record</b>         | Newer platform, actively developed                                                                                                   | <b>200+ ISPs, 500k+ subscribers, 20+ countries, 24/7 support</b>                |

● = clear Jointbox advantage | **amber** = Zal Ultra currently ahead. Zal Ultra figures are from its own published documentation (Aug 2026).

## HOW IT WORKS — BACKEND PROCESS

### Subscriber activation — one atomic transaction

1 price resolved for the seller's tier → 2 wallet debited → 3 invoice raised → 4 expiry stamped → 5 RADIUS profile written (speed, pool or static IP, MAC, session guard) → 6 router pushed

If any step fails the whole transaction rolls back — no charge without service, no service without charge, no duplicate billing on retry (idempotency key).

### Disconnect / static-IP change — verified, not assumed

1 RADIUS CoA Disconnect (RFC 3576) → 2 router-API fallback if unacknowledged → 3 re-query the NAS → 4 retry once if still live → 5 report success ONLY when the router confirms → 6 full attempt trail to audit log

A failed cut raises a visible error and leaves the subscriber marked online — the panel never claims an action the network did not perform.

**Straight answer:** Zal Ultra is the more established product — more NAS vendors, more gateways, a larger install base and a 24/7 team. Choose Jointbox when you care most about **money that reconciles, operations you can trust, and monitoring built in** rather than bolted on.

Sources: docs.onezeroart.com/zalultra (Zal Ultra product documentation & feature list) — retrieved 18 Aug 2026. Jointbox capabilities verified against the shipping codebase.